

SOP-LIFT-5000: Below-the-Hook Lifting Device Inspection

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs inspection and use of below-the-hook lifting devices (spreader bars, lifting beams, custom lifting fixtures) distinct from general rigging hardware under SOP-CRANE-700.

Section 2. Design Certification

Clause 2.1 — Any custom-fabricated lifting device shall be designed and load-rated by a qualified engineer, with the rated capacity permanently marked on the device before first use; a fabricated device without engineering certification shall not be used for lifting.

Section 3. Inspection Frequency

Clause 3.1 — Below-the-hook devices are visually inspected before each use and formally inspected by a qualified person at least annually, or every 3 months for devices in frequent/severe service.

Clause 3.2 — A device with a cracked weld, bent structural member, or illegible capacity marking is removed from service immediately, not scheduled for the next planned inspection.

Section 4. Load Testing

Clause 4.1 — A new or repaired lifting device is load-tested to 125% of rated capacity before first use following fabrication or structural repair; routine annual inspection does not require a repeat load test unless structural repair occurred.

Section 5. Use Restrictions

Clause 5.1 — A lifting device shall never be loaded beyond its marked rated capacity, and shall not be modified in the field without engineering re-certification.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Design certifications, load test results, and inspection records are filed to the Mechanical Lifting File and retained for the life of the device.